

BEFORE THE STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR EXAMINERS

STATE OF COLORADO

CASE NO. 2025-3777, 2025-3927 & 2025-4757

NON-DISCIPLINARY INTERIM CESSATION OF PRACTICE AGREEMENT

IN THE MATTER OF THE LICENSE TO PRACTICE PROFESSIONAL COUNSELING IN THE
STATE OF COLORADO OF STEPHEN GARDEA, LICENSE NO. LPC 19700,

Respondent.

IT IS HEREBY STIPULATED and agreed by and between State Board of Licensed Professional Counselor Examiners (“Board”) and Stephen Gardea (“Respondent”) (collectively “the parties”), as follows:

1. Respondent was licensed to practice as a professional counselor (“LPC”) in the State of Colorado on August 16, 2023, and was issued license number LPC 19700, which Respondent has held continuously since that date.

2. The Board has jurisdiction over Respondent and over the subject matter of this proceeding.

3. On September 5, 2025, the Board reviewed materials relating to case numbers 2025-3777, 2025-3927 and 2025-4757 that indicates Respondent may have violated provisions within 12-245-224(1), C.R.S.

4. Respondent denies any and all allegations of a violation of the Mental Health Practice Act. Respondent voluntarily enters into this agreement to facilitate further evaluation of the issues related to Board case numbers 2025-3777, 2025-3927 and 2025-4757

5. Based upon the information and the totality of the circumstances, Respondent has offered to enter into an agreement for Respondent not to practice as a LPC in the interim as set forth in more detail below, and the Board has authorized the parties to enter into an agreement for Respondent to limit his practice as a LPC

6. The parties have agreed to enter into this Non-Disciplinary Interim Cessation of Practice Agreement (“Interim Agreement”) pending further evaluation and investigation of Respondent to determine what further actions, if any, are warranted. Any summary suspension that could be imposed by the Board is hereby stayed pursuant to the terms of this Interim Agreement.

7. Respondent agrees that he will not perform any act requiring a license issued by the Board while this Interim Agreement is in effect.

8. This Interim Agreement shall remain in effect until such time as the parties reach a final disposition of this case or, in the event summary suspension proceedings are initiated, an order for summary suspension enters.

9. The Board agrees that it will not institute summary suspension proceedings while this Interim Agreement is in effect so long as the Respondent remains in compliance with this Interim Agreement and so long as the Board does not learn of new information that would indicate that summary suspension is warranted.

10. Nothing in this Interim Agreement shall constitute disciplinary action, a finding that Respondent has engaged in unprofessional conduct, or any admission by Respondent of unprofessional conduct. There have been no final determinations regarding Respondent's professional competence or professional conduct. Nothing in this Interim Agreement shall constitute final action as defined in section 24-4-102(1), C.R.S.

11. Nothing in this Interim Agreement shall preclude the Board from initiating disciplinary action pursuant to section 12-245-224, C.R.S., or issuing a Final Agency Order while this Interim Agreement is in effect.

12. Respondent understands that Respondent has the right to be represented by counsel of Respondent's choice in this matter, and Respondent has voluntarily chosen to proceed without representation.

13. The terms of this Interim Agreement were mutually negotiated and determined.

14. Both parties acknowledge that they understand the legal consequences of this Interim Agreement, both parties enter into this Interim Agreement voluntarily, and both parties agree that no term or condition of this Interim Agreement is unconscionable.

15. This Interim Agreement and all its terms constitute a valid board order for purposes of section 12-245-224(1)(b), C.R.S.

16. Invalidity of any portion of this Interim Agreement by judgment or court order shall in no way affect any other provision, which provision shall remain in full force and effect.

17. This Interim Agreement shall be effective upon signature by Respondent. Respondent acknowledges that the Board may choose not to accept the terms of this Interim Agreement and that if the Interim Agreement is not approved by the Board and signed by a Board member or other authorized person, it is void.

18. This Interim Agreement constitutes the entire agreement between the parties, and there are no other agreements or promises, written or oral, which modify, interpret, construe, or affect this Interim Agreement.

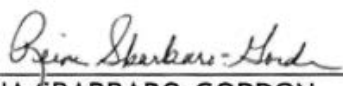
19. All costs and expenses incurred by Respondent to comply with this Interim


STEPHEN GARDEA

Date: 9/10/2025

THE FOREGOING Non-Disciplinary Interim Cessation of Practice Agreement is effective upon signature by Respondent, above, and is approved this 11th day of September, 2025.

FOR THE COLORADO STATE BOARD OF LICENSED
PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR EXAMINERS


REINA BARBARO-GORDON

Program Director

By delegated authority of the Board